took over, mentions of vikas increased substantially during the first two years, 2014–2016.

However, from 2018 onwards, that focus almost halved, as the government shifted tack to other issues. Yet, it is still 60 per cent more than it was in 2014 and way higher than most other cultural topics. The vikas discourse remains the fourth highest in the BJP's communications outreach, way above its core issues.

Terrorism, Cow and Temple Are Core Issues but Underplayed in Volume

In October 2008, the BJP issued a press release written as an open letter to 'Congressmen and your other pseudo-secular friends'. It selectively quoted Gandhi's writings on proselytisation and cow slaughter, saying that even Mahatma Gandhi, who cannot be accused of having any ill will towards Christianity, was constrained to say the following:[20]

I disbelieve in the conversion of one person by another. My effort should never to be to undermine another's faith. This implies belief in the truth of all religions and, therefore, respect for them. It implies true humility. (Young India: April 23, 1931)

It is impossible for me to reconcile myself to the idea of conversion after the style that goes on in India and elsewhere today. It is an error which is perhaps the greatest impediment to the world's progress toward peace. Why should a Christian want to convert a Hindu to Christianity? Why should he not be satisfied if the Hindu is a good or godly man? (Harijan: January 30, 1937)

[…]

My fear is that though Christian friends nowadays do not say or admit it that Hindu religion is untrue, they must harbour in their breast that Hinduism is an error and that Christianity, as they believe it, is the only true religion. So far as one can understand the present (Christian) effort, it is to uproot Hinduism from her very foundation and replace it by another faith. (Harijan: March 13, 1937)

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